01

1 Nyāya

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Nyāya is the school of logic, epistemology and critical debate, classically associated with Gautama's Nyāya-sūtra.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Its concern is not logic in an abstract formalist sense alone, but valid cognition as a means to the removal of error and finally liberation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Its concern is not logic in an abstract formalist sense alone, but valid cognition as a means to the removal of error and finally liberation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Its concern is not logic in an abstract formalist sense alone, but valid cognition as a means to the removal of error and finally liberation.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya is the school of logic, epistemology and critical debate, classically associated with Gautama's Nyāya-sūtra.**

02

2 Vaiśeṣika

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Vaiśeṣika, associated with Kaṇāda's Vaiśeṣika-sūtra, is primarily an ontological school.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ It classifies reality into padārthas and develops atomism.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ It classifies reality into padārthas and develops atomism.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Vaiśeṣika, associated with Kaṇāda's Vaiśeṣika-sūtra, is primarily an ontological school.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Vaiśeṣika, associated with Kaṇāda's Vaiśeṣika-sūtra, is primarily an ontological school.**

03

3 Their convergence

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯▯ In UPSC, it is usually best to treat them together while still noting where a point is distinctly Nyāya (e.g. pramāṇa, anyathākhyāti) or distinctly Vaiśeṣika (e.g. padārtha, atomism).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Later Navya-Nyāya, especially through Gaṅgeśa, sharpens the analytic and technical vocabulary of the tradition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ In UPSC, it is usually best to treat them together while still noting where a point is distinctly Nyāya (e.g. pramāṇa, anyathākhyāti) or distinctly Vaiśeṣika (e.g. padārtha, atomism).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Over time the two schools converge into a synthetic Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika system.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Over time the two schools converge into a synthetic Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika system.**

04

1 Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Padārtha means what is nameable and knowable.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Classical Vaiśeṣika finally recognizes seven padārthas.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Historically, Kaṇāda's older list is often taken as six, with abhāva added later.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Padārtha means what is nameable and knowable.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Padārtha means what is nameable and knowable.**

05

Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Dravya is that in which qualities and actions inhere and which can serve as a material or ontological base.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Dravya is that in which qualities and actions inhere and which can serve as a material or ontological base.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Dravya is that in which qualities and actions inhere and which can serve as a material or ontological base.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Dravya is that in which qualities and actions inhere and which can serve as a material or ontological base.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Dravya is that in which qualities and actions inhere and which can serve as a material or ontological base.**

06

Distinction

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯▯ A common trap is to forget that ākāśa, kāla and dik are themselves substances, not merely abstract conditions.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ A common trap is to forget that ākāśa, kāla and dik are themselves substances, not merely abstract conditions.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ A common trap is to forget that ākāśa, kāla and dik are themselves substances, not merely abstract conditions.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ A common trap is to forget that ākāśa, kāla and dik are themselves substances, not merely abstract conditions.

ANSWER LINE: **▯▯ A common trap is to forget that ākāśa, kāla and dik are themselves substances, not merely abstract conditions.**

07

Example

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ A pot is a substance because colour, number, conjunction and motion can inhere in it.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ A pot is a substance because colour, number, conjunction and motion can inhere in it.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ A pot is a substance because colour, number, conjunction and motion can inhere in it.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ A pot is a substance because colour, number, conjunction and motion can inhere in it.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ A pot is a substance because colour, number, conjunction and motion can inhere in it.**

08

Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Guṇa is a dependent ontological feature that inheres in a substance but does not itself possess further qualities or actions in the same way.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ The traditional list gives twenty-four qualities:

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

saṃskāra (dispositional tendency/momentum)

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Guṇa is a dependent ontological feature that inheres in a substance but does not itself possess further qualities or actions in the same way.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Guṇa is a dependent ontological feature that inheres in a substance but does not itself possess further qualities or actions in the same way.**

09

Philosophical significance

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯▯ The list is notable because mental items like cognition, desire and pleasure are treated as qualities, not as the essence of self.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ The list is notable because mental items like cognition, desire and pleasure are treated as qualities, not as the essence of self.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ The list is notable because mental items like cognition, desire and pleasure are treated as qualities, not as the essence of self.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ The list is notable because mental items like cognition, desire and pleasure are treated as qualities, not as the essence of self.

ANSWER LINE: **▯▯ The list is notable because mental items like cognition, desire and pleasure are treated as qualities, not as the essence of self.**

10

5 Karma (motion/action)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Karma here means physical motion/action, not moral karma.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Motion is important because it generates conjunction and disjunction, central to causation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Motion is important because it generates conjunction and disjunction, central to causation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Karma here means physical motion/action, not moral karma.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Karma here means physical motion/action, not moral karma.**

11

Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Sāmānya is the real universal, one-in-many, eternal and present in multiple particulars.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Universals may be discussed through higher and lower ordering, often expressed as para and apara distinctions.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Universals may be discussed through higher and lower ordering, often expressed as para and apara distinctions.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □ Sāmānya is the real universal, one-in-many, eternal and present in multiple particulars.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Sāmānya is the real universal, one-in-many, eternal and present in multiple particulars.**

12

Argument

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

2. □ Mere resemblance is insufficient unless some objective commonness grounds the classification.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

3. □ Therefore a universal must be real.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. □ Therefore a universal must be real.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: 1. □ We genuinely classify many individuals under one concept: "cow", "pot", "substance".

ANSWER LINE: **1. □ We genuinely classify many individuals under one concept: "cow", "pot", "substance".**

13

Presupposition

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□□ The argument presupposes realist semantics: common predication reflects objective common structure in the world.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ The argument presupposes realist semantics: common predication reflects objective common structure in the world.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ The argument presupposes realist semantics: common predication reflects objective common structure in the world.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □□ The argument presupposes realist semantics: common predication reflects objective common structure in the world.

ANSWER LINE: **□□ The argument presupposes realist semantics: common predication reflects objective common structure in the world.**

14

Distinction

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Vaiśeṣika realism here opposes the Buddhist apoha theory, which explains universals through exclusion rather than real common entities.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Vaiśeṣika realism here opposes the Buddhist apoha theory, which explains universals through exclusion rather than real common entities.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Vaiśeṣika realism here opposes the Buddhist apoha theory, which explains universals through exclusion rather than real common entities.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Vaiśeṣika realism here opposes the Buddhist apoha theory, which explains universals through exclusion rather than real common entities.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Vaiśeṣika realism here opposes the Buddhist apoha theory, which explains universals through exclusion rather than real common entities.**

15

Example

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ "Cow-ness" is one universal present in many cows.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ "Cow-ness" is one universal present in many cows.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ "Cow-ness" is one universal present in many cows.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □ "Cow-ness" is one universal present in many cows.

ANSWER LINE: **□ "Cow-ness" is one universal present in many cows.**

16

Objection

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ If the universal is one, how can it be wholly present in many places?

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ If the universal is one, how can it be wholly present in many places?

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ If the universal is one, how can it be wholly present in many places?

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ If the universal is one, how can it be wholly present in many places?

ANSWER LINE: **▯ If the universal is one, how can it be wholly present in many places?**

17

Reply

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The universal is not spatially divided like a physical thing; it is a single eternal entity instantiated in many particulars through samavāya (inherence).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ The universal is not spatially divided like a physical thing; it is a single eternal entity instantiated in many particulars through samavāya (inherence).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ The universal is not spatially divided like a physical thing; it is a single eternal entity instantiated in many particulars through samavāya (inherence).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ The universal is not spatially divided like a physical thing; it is a single eternal entity instantiated in many particulars through samavāya (inherence).

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The universal is not spatially divided like a physical thing; it is a single eternal entity instantiated in many particulars through samavāya (inherence).**

18

7 Jāti-bādhaka: six impediments to universalhood

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Not every general term names a real universal (jāti, class-universal); where a proposed jāti is blocked, Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treats it as an imposed property or limiting condition (upādhi, adjunct), not as a new padārtha.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Universals are perceived in determinate perception (savikalpaka-pratyakṣa) such as "this is a cow"; their presence is by samavāya, not by spatial containment; and apoha is circular because exclusion of non-cows presupposes a stable cow-class or at least stable exclusion-domains.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Dignāga and Dharmakīrti-style apoha theory argues that universals are unperceived, causally inert, and cannot be wholly present in many places at once.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Not every general term names a real universal (jāti, class-universal); where a proposed jāti is blocked, Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treats it as an imposed property or limiting condition (upādhi, adjunct), not as a new padārtha.

ANSWER LINE: **Not every general term names a real universal (jāti, class-universal); where a proposed jāti is blocked, Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treats it as an imposed property or limiting condition (upādhi, adjunct), not as a new padārtha.**

19

8 Viśeṣa (particularity)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Viśeṣa is the ultimate individuator residing only in eternal substances: the paramāṇus of earth, water, fire and air, and the eternal instances of ākāśa, kāla, dik, ātman and manas.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Two atoms of earth may be alike in all universals and ordinary qualities; without viśeṣa they would be indistinguishable and, by the identity of indiscernibles, would collapse into one.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Viśeṣa gives the Vaiśeṣika school its name because the system explains plurality through irreducible particularity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Viśeṣa is the ultimate individuator residing only in eternal substances: the paramāṇus of earth, water, fire and air, and the eternal instances of ākāśa, kāla, dik, ātman and manas.

ANSWER LINE: **Viśeṣa is the ultimate individuator residing only in eternal substances: the paramāṇus of earth, water, fire and air, and the eternal instances of ākāśa, kāla, dik, ātman and manas.**

20

Objection: regress of differentiators

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Critics argue that "self-differentiating" names the stopping point rather than proving it; viśeṣa is a stipulated terminus of individuation.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Viśeṣas are svato-vyāvartaka (self-differentiating): they distinguish both their loci and themselves by their own nature.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Viśeṣas are svato-vyāvartaka (self-differentiating): they distinguish both their loci and themselves by their own nature.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Critics argue that "self-differentiating" names the stopping point rather than proving it; viśeṣa is a stipulated terminus of individuation.

ANSWER LINE: **If viśeṣa differentiates one atom from another, what differentiates one viśeṣa from another?**

21

Objection: imperceptible ontological IOU

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Viśeṣa is imperceptible and appears to be posited solely to do the explanatory job of individuating exactly similar eternals.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika frames the posit inferentially: plurality of exactly similar eternal substances is otherwise inexplicable, and Nyāya reduces arthāpatti (postulation) to inference rather than making it a separate pramāṇa.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Jaina, Buddhist and Advaita critiques often target viśeṣa and samavāya as the weakest joints of the system; Śrīharṣa's Khaṇḍanakhaṇḍakhādya attacks Nyāya definitions systematically.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika frames the posit inferentially: plurality of exactly similar eternal substances is otherwise inexplicable, and Nyāya reduces arthāpatti (postulation) to inference rather than making it a separate pramāṇa.

ANSWER LINE: **Viśeṣa is imperceptible and appears to be posited solely to do the explanatory job of individuating exactly similar eternals.**

22

9 Samavāya (inherence)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Samavāya is the eternal, single, imperceptible-yet-inferred inseparable relation (ayutasiddha-sambandha) that holds where relata cannot be established as separable in the relevant ontological mode.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

It holds between five standard pairs: part–whole, substance–quality, substance–motion, universal–particular, and eternal substance–its viśeṣa.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Later exposition calls samavāya one and not locally multiplied; "all-pervading" should be read as one relation operating wherever the required relata obtain, not as a tenth spatial substance.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Samavāya is the eternal, single, imperceptible-yet-inferred inseparable relation (ayutasiddha-sambandha) that holds where relata cannot be established as separable in the relevant ontological mode.

ANSWER LINE: **Samavāya is the eternal, single, imperceptible-yet-inferred inseparable relation (ayutasiddha-sambandha) that holds where relata cannot be established as separable in the relevant ontological mode.**

23

Distinction from saṃyoga

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Inseparability is necessary for samavāya, but □□ not by itself sufficient unless the specific ontological dependence relation is shown; mere closeness is not inherence.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Inseparability is necessary for samavāya, but □□ not by itself sufficient unless the specific ontological dependence relation is shown; mere closeness is not inherence.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Inseparability is necessary for samavāya, but □□ not by itself sufficient unless the specific ontological dependence relation is shown; mere closeness is not inherence.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Inseparability is necessary for samavāya, but □□ not by itself sufficient unless the specific ontological dependence relation is shown; mere closeness is not inherence.

ANSWER LINE: **Inseparability is necessary for samavāya, but □□ not by itself sufficient unless the specific ontological dependence relation is shown; mere closeness is not inherence.**

24

Objection: relation-regress

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Samavāya is svarūpa-sambandha (self-linking relation): it relates by its own nature and needs no further relator.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Samavāya is svarūpa-sambandha (self-linking relation): it relates by its own nature and needs no further relator.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

This is a stipulated terminus; every relational ontology must stop somewhere, and critics such as Buddhists and Śrīharṣa press the charge that Nyāya stops regress here while using regress against opponents.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: If samavāya relates A and B, a further relation seems needed to relate samavāya to A and to B, generating anavasthā (infinite regress).

ANSWER LINE: **If samavāya relates A and B, a further relation seems needed to relate samavāya to A and to B, generating anavasthā (infinite regress).**

25

Objection: one or many samavāyas?

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Samavāya is one and eternal; parsimony is the Vaiśeṣika reason for not multiplying inherence-relations.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

If samavāya is one, it is hard to explain why it relates this quality to this substance rather than to all substances.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The relata themselves determine the relation's operation: samavāya is not a free-floating glue but the inseparable tie manifest only where the relevant terms exist.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Samavāya is one and eternal; parsimony is the Vaiśeṣika reason for not multiplying inherence-relations.

ANSWER LINE: **Samavāya is one and eternal; parsimony is the Vaiśeṣika reason for not multiplying inherence-relations.**

26

Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Abhāva is the category of absence or non-existence.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. prāgabhāva — prior non-existence

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

2. pradhvaṃsābhāva — posterior non-existence/destruction

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Abhāva is the category of absence or non-existence.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Abhāva is the category of absence or non-existence.**

27

(a) Prāgabhāva

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ It has no beginning, but ends when the effect is produced.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ It has no beginning, but ends when the effect is produced.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ The non-existence of an effect before its production.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ The non-existence of an effect before its production.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The non-existence of an effect before its production.**

28

(b) Pradhvaṃsābhāva

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The non-existence of a thing after its destruction.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ It begins with destruction and has no end.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ It begins with destruction and has no end.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ The non-existence of a thing after its destruction.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The non-existence of a thing after its destruction.**

29

(c) Atyantābhāva

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Absolute non-existence: a thing is absent in a locus for all times.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Absolute non-existence: a thing is absent in a locus for all times.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Absolute non-existence: a thing is absent in a locus for all times.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Absolute non-existence: a thing is absent in a locus for all times.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Absolute non-existence: a thing is absent in a locus for all times.**

30

(d) Anyonyābhāva

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ "A pot is not a cloth" means pot and cloth are different entities.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ "A pot is not a cloth" means pot and cloth are different entities.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ "A pot is not a cloth" means pot and cloth are different entities.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ "A pot is not a cloth" means pot and cloth are different entities.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Mutual non-existence or reciprocal difference.**

31

2024 distinction: air does not have heat vs air is not fire

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ "Air does not have heat" is best treated as atyantābhāva with respect to heat in air.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ "Air is not fire" is anyonyābhāva, because it expresses difference between two entities.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ Therefore they are not the same kind of absence.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ "Air does not have heat" is best treated as atyantābhāva with respect to heat in air.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ "Air does not have heat" is best treated as atyantābhāva with respect to heat in air.**

32

2023 issue: counterpositive (pratiyogin)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Every absence is the absence of something; that absent positive term is the pratiyogin or counterpositive.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ This shows abhāva is not sheer blankness; it has structured intentional content.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ This shows abhāva is not sheer blankness; it has structured intentional content.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ This shows abhāva is not sheer blankness; it has structured intentional content.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Every absence is the absence of something; that absent positive term is the pratiyogin or counterpositive.**

33

Gautama's definition (2025)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The classical Nyāya definition states in substance: "indriyārtha-sannikarṣa-utpannaṃ jñānam avyapadeśyam avyabhicāri vyavasāyātmakam pratyakṣam".

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ UPSC expects clause-by-clause unpacking.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ UPSC expects clause-by-clause unpacking.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ The classical Nyāya definition states in substance: "indriyārtha-sannikarṣa-utpannaṃ jñānam avyapadeśyam avyabhicāri vyavasāyātmakam pratyakṣam".

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The classical Nyāya definition states in substance: "indriyārtha-sannikarṣa-utpannaṃ jñānam avyapadeśyam avyabhicāri vyavasāyātmakam pratyakṣam".**

34

Clause-by-clause analysis

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. indriyārtha-sannikarṣa — sense-object contact

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Perception is not constituted by words as words.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ This marks perception as causally immediate relative to the relevant sense relation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

3. avyapadeśyam — non-verbal / not dependent on testimony

ANSWER LINE: **1. indriyārtha-sannikarṣa — sense-object contact**

35

Nirvikalpaka and savikalpaka perception

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Nirvikalpaka perception is indeterminate, pre-predicative awareness.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Savikalpaka perception is determinate: qualified, nameable awareness such as "this is a blue pot".

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ The tradition often uses nirvikalpaka to explain how raw awareness can ground determinate judgment.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Nirvikalpaka perception is indeterminate, pre-predicative awareness.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nirvikalpaka perception is indeterminate, pre-predicative awareness.**

36

The six sannikarṣas

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

2. saṃyukta-samavāya — inherence in what is conjoined

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. saṃyukta-samavāya — inherence in what is conjoined

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. saṃyukta-samaveta-samavāya — inherence in what inheres in what is conjoined

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ These are technical tools for explaining how the senses can apprehend not just substances, but also qualities, universals and absences.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya elaborates six sense-object relations:**

37

Extraordinary perception (alaukika) (2023, 2019)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

perception through the universal; by apprehending a universal one can perceptually relate to all its instances in a distinctive way.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

perception through the universal; by apprehending a universal one can perceptually relate to all its instances in a distinctive way.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

a case where prior cognition mediates present perception; e.g. one may in a derivative sense "see" sandalwood as fragrant.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ This supports Nyāya realism about universals: universals are perceived, not merely inferred.

ANSWER LINE: **perception through the universal; by apprehending a universal one can perceptually relate to all its instances in a distinctive way.**

38

Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Anumāna is knowledge arising through a sign (liṅga/hetu, probans) known to be invariably related to the probandum (sādhya).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Anumāna is knowledge arising through a sign (liṅga/hetu, probans) known to be invariably related to the probandum (sādhya).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Anumāna is knowledge arising through a sign (liṅga/hetu, probans) known to be invariably related to the probandum (sādhya).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Anumāna is knowledge arising through a sign (liṅga/hetu, probans) known to be invariably related to the probandum (sādhya).

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Anumāna is knowledge arising through a sign (liṅga/hetu, probans) known to be invariably related to the probandum (sādhya).**

39

Five members of inference

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

3. ▯ udāharaṇa — wherever there is smoke, there is fire, as in a kitchen.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

5. ▯ nigamana — therefore the hill has fire.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

5. ▯ nigamana — therefore the hill has fire.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: 3. ▯ udāharaṇa — wherever there is smoke, there is fire, as in a kitchen.

ANSWER LINE: **3. ▯ udāharaṇa — wherever there is smoke, there is fire, as in a kitchen.**

40

Five characteristics of a valid hetu

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. ▯ pakṣadharmatā — the hetu is present in the subject under consideration.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

4. ▯ abādhita — the sādhya is not contradicted by stronger knowledge.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. ▯ vipakṣa-asattva — the hetu is absent in dissimilar negative instances.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

4. ▯ abādhita — the sādhya is not contradicted by stronger knowledge.

ANSWER LINE: **1. ▯ pakṣadharmatā — the hetu is present in the subject under consideration.**

41

4 Vyāpti-grahaṇa: grasping invariable concomitance

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Vyāpti-grahaṇa is the chain by which Nyāya claims to know the universal relation required for inference; it is the core reply to Cārvāka scepticism about anumāna.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Vyāpti-grahaṇa is the chain by which Nyāya claims to know the universal relation required for inference; it is the core reply to Cārvāka scepticism about anumāna.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Vyāpti-grahaṇa is the chain by which Nyāya claims to know the universal relation required for inference; it is the core reply to Cārvāka scepticism about anumāna.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Vyāpti-grahaṇa is the chain by which Nyāya claims to know the universal relation required for inference; it is the core reply to Cārvāka scepticism about anumāna.

ANSWER LINE: **Vyāpti-grahaṇa is the chain by which Nyāya claims to know the universal relation required for inference; it is the core reply to Cārvāka scepticism about anumāna.**

42

Vyāpti defined

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Vyāpti is invariable, unconditional concomitance (avinābhāva-niyama) between the hetu/liṅga (probans, e.g. smoke) and the sādhya (probandum, e.g. fire).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Viṣamavyāpti / asamavyāpti is unequal extension: all smoke is pervaded by fire, but not all fire is pervaded by smoke.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Viṣamavyāpti / asamavyāpti is unequal extension: all smoke is pervaded by fire, but not all fire is pervaded by smoke.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Viṣamavyāpti / asamavyāpti is unequal extension: all smoke is pervaded by fire, but not all fire is pervaded by smoke.

ANSWER LINE: **Vyāpti is invariable, unconditional concomitance (avinābhāva-niyama) between the hetu/liṅga (probans, e.g. smoke) and the sādhya (probandum, e.g. fire).**

43

Bhūyodarśana: repeated positive and negative observation

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

The knower also observes co-absence (vyatireka) in negative instances: where fire is absent, smoke is absent.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Bhūyodarśana alone is not sufficient, because repeated observation remains a finite sample and cannot by itself yield an unrestricted universal.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Bhūyodarśana alone is not sufficient, because repeated observation remains a finite sample and cannot by itself yield an unrestricted universal.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Bhūyodarśana alone is not sufficient, because repeated observation remains a finite sample and cannot by itself yield an unrestricted universal.

ANSWER LINE: **The knower observes co-presence (anvaya) in many positive instances: smoke with fire in kitchens, hearths and similar cases.**

44

Vyabhicāra-adarśana: absence of counter-instance

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

The investigator searches for deviation (vyabhicāra) and does not find a case where the hetu occurs without the sādhya.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

This strengthens the universal but still needs the removal of hidden conditions.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

This strengthens the universal but still needs the removal of hidden conditions.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

The investigator searches for deviation (vyabhicāra) and does not find a case where the hetu occurs without the sādhya.

ANSWER LINE: **The investigator searches for deviation (vyabhicāra) and does not find a case where the hetu occurs without the sādhya.**

45

Upādhi-nirāsa: removal of conditioning adjunct

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Upādhi is a conditioning adjunct: sādhya-vyāpakatve sati sādhana-avyāpakaḥ — that which pervades the sādhya but does not pervade the hetu.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

In the bad inference "the hill has smoke because it has fire", wet fuel (ārdra-indhana) is the upādhi: wherever there is smoke there is wet fuel, but not wherever there is fire is there wet fuel.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore fire does not unconditionally pervade smoke; the fire-to-smoke inference is conditional and fails.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Upādhi is a conditioning adjunct: sādhya-vyāpakatve sati sādhana-avyāpakaḥ — that which pervades the sādhya but does not pervade the hetu.

ANSWER LINE: **Upādhi is a conditioning adjunct: sādhya-vyāpakatve sati sādhana-avyāpakaḥ — that which pervades the sādhya but does not pervade the hetu.**

46

Tarka: reductive doubt-removal

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Tarka is hypothetical or counterfactual reasoning that removes residual doubt by showing the unacceptable consequence of the contrary supposition.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Tarka is hypothetical or counterfactual reasoning that removes residual doubt by showing the unacceptable consequence of the contrary supposition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Tarka is pramāṇa-anugrāhaka (an aid to pramāṇas), not an independent pramāṇa; it supports perception and inference by eliminating the rival supposition.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

If smoke were not pervaded by fire, smoke could occur without fire; this contradicts uniform experience and would make the causal order unintelligible.

ANSWER LINE: **Tarka is hypothetical or counterfactual reasoning that removes residual doubt by showing the unacceptable consequence of the contrary supposition.**

47

Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa: universal-mediated perception

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

As noted in §3.2, sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa is extraordinary (alaukika) perception through the universal.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

As noted in §3.2, sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa is extraordinary (alaukika) perception through the universal.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

This is the specifically Nyāya move against the problem of induction: because jāti is real, the universal can be cognitively grasped, not merely guessed from samples.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

This is the specifically Nyāya move against the problem of induction: because jāti is real, the universal can be cognitively grasped, not merely guessed from samples.

ANSWER LINE: **As noted in §3.2, sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa is extraordinary (alaukika) perception through the universal.**

48

Pakṣadharmatā and parāmarśa

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

The immediate cause (karaṇa) of inferential cognition is the subsumptive reflection: "this hill possesses smoke which is pervaded by fire".

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The immediate cause (karaṇa) of inferential cognition is the subsumptive reflection: "this hill possesses smoke which is pervaded by fire".

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The five-membered syllogism makes parāmarśa communicable: pratijñā states the thesis, hetu states the sign, udāharaṇa states vyāpti with example, upanaya applies it to the pakṣa, and nigamana states the conclusion.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: The hetu must be known to exist in the pakṣa: this hill has smoke.

ANSWER LINE: **The hetu must be known to exist in the pakṣa: this hill has smoke.**

49

Hetvābhāsa as the negative test of vyāpti

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Savyabhicāra violates vipakṣa-asattva, asiddha violates pakṣadharmatā, bādhita violates abādhita, satpratipakṣa violates asatpratipakṣa, and viruddha reverses the direction of vyāpti itself.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Savyabhicāra violates vipakṣa-asattva, asiddha violates pakṣadharmatā, bādhita violates abādhita, satpratipakṣa violates asatpratipakṣa, and viruddha reverses the direction of vyāpti itself.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Savyabhicāra violates vipakṣa-asattva, asiddha violates pakṣadharmatā, bādhita violates abādhita, satpratipakṣa violates asatpratipakṣa, and viruddha reverses the direction of vyāpti itself.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: Savyabhicāra violates vipakṣa-asattva, asiddha violates pakṣadharmatā, bādhita violates abādhita, satpratipakṣa violates asatpratipakṣa, and viruddha reverses the direction of vyāpti itself.

ANSWER LINE: **Savyabhicāra violates vipakṣa-asattva, asiddha violates pakṣadharmatā, bādhita violates abādhita, satpratipakṣa violates asatpratipakṣa, and viruddha reverses the direction of vyāpti itself.**

50

Objection: Cārvāka and the Humean parallel

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

No finite observation licenses a universal; upādhi-elimination can never be completed; tarka presupposes inference and is circular; and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa looks like an ad hoc posit.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The parallel is that observed regularity alone does not logically entail future or universal necessity.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The parallel is that observed regularity alone does not logically entail future or universal necessity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

No finite observation licenses a universal; upādhi-elimination can never be completed; tarka presupposes inference and is circular; and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa looks like an ad hoc posit.

ANSWER LINE: **No finite observation licenses a universal; upādhi-elimination can never be completed; tarka presupposes inference and is circular; and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa looks like an ad hoc posit.**

51

Reply: Nyāya answer

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

The demand for mathematical certainty from empirical universals is misplaced; Nyāya claims warranted cognition, not omniscient enumeration by ordinary knowers.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The demand for mathematical certainty from empirical universals is misplaced; Nyāya claims warranted cognition, not omniscient enumeration by ordinary knowers.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa is not ad hoc within Nyāya ontology, because universals are real padārthas and can be presented in cognition.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

The demand for mathematical certainty from empirical universals is misplaced; Nyāya claims warranted cognition, not omniscient enumeration by ordinary knowers.

ANSWER LINE: **The demand for mathematical certainty from empirical universals is misplaced; Nyāya claims warranted cognition, not omniscient enumeration by ordinary knowers.**

52

5 Upamāna (comparison)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ If one is told that a gavaya resembles a cow, later encountering such an animal yields knowledge that this is what the word denotes.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Upamāna gives knowledge of the relation between a word and its referent through resemblance.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ The point is semantic acquisition via similarity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Upamāna gives knowledge of the relation between a word and its referent through resemblance.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Upamāna gives knowledge of the relation between a word and its referent through resemblance.**

53

Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Śabda is valid verbal testimony, classically understood as āptavākya, the statement of an āpta — a trustworthy competent person.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Śabda is valid verbal testimony, classically understood as āptavākya, the statement of an āpta — a trustworthy competent person.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Śabda is valid verbal testimony, classically understood as āptavākya, the statement of an āpta — a trustworthy competent person.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Śabda is valid verbal testimony, classically understood as āptavākya, the statement of an āpta — a trustworthy competent person.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Śabda is valid verbal testimony, classically understood as āptavākya, the statement of an āpta — a trustworthy competent person.**

54

Argument

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. ▯ Many things cannot be directly perceived by each knower.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1. ▯ Many things cannot be directly perceived by each knower.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. ▯ Therefore testimony must be recognized as an independent pramāṇa when it comes from a trustworthy source.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

1. ▯ Many things cannot be directly perceived by each knower.

ANSWER LINE: **1. ▯ Many things cannot be directly perceived by each knower.**

55

Vedic testimony

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ In later Nyāya, its authority is often connected with God as omniscient author.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ In later Nyāya, its authority is often connected with God as omniscient author.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ In later Nyāya, its authority is often connected with God as omniscient author.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Nyāya accepts the Veda as valid testimony.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya accepts the Veda as valid testimony.**

56

7 Why memory (smṛti) is not a pramāṇa (2024)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ A pramāṇa must produce fresh, true cognition of what is not already known in that mode.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Therefore memory may be psychologically useful but is not epistemically pramāṇa in the technical sense.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ Therefore memory may be psychologically useful but is not epistemically pramāṇa in the technical sense.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Memory reproduces a past cognition; it does not generate novel knowledge.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Memory reproduces a past cognition; it does not generate novel knowledge.**

57

8 Svataḥ and parataḥ prāmāṇya (2025)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ That means both validity and invalidity of cognition are known through external conditions or later confirmation/disconfirmation.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ That means both validity and invalidity of cognition are known through external conditions or later confirmation/disconfirmation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Contrast: Mīmāṃsā generally takes validity to be self-manifest (svataḥ) while invalidity is known later.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ This is a standard UPSC trap: Nyāya is not merely parataḥ for invalidity; it is parataḥ for both.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Nyāya defends parataḥ-prāmāṇya and parataḥ-aprāmāṇya.**

58

9 Naiyāyika-Buddhist debate on pramāṇa and pramāṇaphala (2025)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

The pramāṇa is the instrument or means; the resulting true cognition is its fruit.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The pramāṇa is the instrument or means; the resulting true cognition is its fruit.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The pramāṇa is the instrument or means; the resulting true cognition is its fruit.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □ Nyāya: pramāṇa and pramāṇa-phala / pramiti are different.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Nyāya: pramāṇa and pramāṇa-phala / pramiti are different.**

59

1 Anyathākhyāti stated precisely

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□□ Error is therefore misplacement or wrong synthesis, not apprehension of a non-entity.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Nyāya explains illusion through anyathākhyāti.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ Error is therefore misplacement or wrong synthesis, not apprehension of a non-entity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Error is therefore misplacement or wrong synthesis, not apprehension of a non-entity.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Nyāya explains illusion through anyathākhyāti.**

60

2 Mechanism

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

2. □ A past impression of silver is activated.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

3. □ Through jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa, the silver becomes present to consciousness in a derivative extraordinary perceptual way.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

5. □ The erroneous cognition "this is silver" results.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: 1. □ A present perceptual base exists — e.g. shell.

ANSWER LINE: **1. □ A present perceptual base exists — e.g. shell.**

61

3 Presupposition

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯▯ Nyāya preserves realism even in illusion: cognition goes wrong, but the world is not ontologically downgraded into dream-stuff.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ Nyāya preserves realism even in illusion: cognition goes wrong, but the world is not ontologically downgraded into dream-stuff.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ Nyāya preserves realism even in illusion: cognition goes wrong, but the world is not ontologically downgraded into dream-stuff.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ Nyāya preserves realism even in illusion: cognition goes wrong, but the world is not ontologically downgraded into dream-stuff.

ANSWER LINE: **▯▯ Nyāya preserves realism even in illusion: cognition goes wrong, but the world is not ontologically downgraded into dream-stuff.**

62

5 Jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa and anyathākhyāti (2019)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Nyāya uses jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa to explain how the silver can be experientially present without being physically present in that location.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ It bridges memory and presentative awareness while preserving realism.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ It bridges memory and presentative awareness while preserving realism.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Nyāya uses jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa to explain how the silver can be experientially present without being physically present in that location.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya uses jñānalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa to explain how the silver can be experientially present without being physically present in that location.**

63

6 Naiyāyika response to anirvacanīya-khyāti (2021)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Nyāya objects that the Advaitin's "neither real nor unreal" status is obscure and violates classical logical alternatives.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ For Nyāya, the error-object must be explainable using real entities and cognitive misrelation; no third ontological status is needed.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ For Nyāya, the error-object must be explainable using real entities and cognitive misrelation; no third ontological status is needed.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Nyāya objects that the Advaitin's "neither real nor unreal" status is obscure and violates classical logical alternatives.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya objects that the Advaitin's "neither real nor unreal" status is obscure and violates classical logical alternatives.**

64

1 Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The self (ātman) is a real enduring substance distinct from body, senses and mind.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Consciousness is not its essence but an adventitious quality arising under proper conditions.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Consciousness is not its essence but an adventitious quality arising under proper conditions.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Consciousness is not its essence but an adventitious quality arising under proper conditions.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The self (ātman) is a real enduring substance distinct from body, senses and mind.**

65

2 Six Nyāya arguments for the self (2024)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

The following six-track presentation is the standard exam-ready arrangement.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The following six-track presentation is the standard exam-ready arrangement.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

1. ▯ From desire (icchā) and aversion (dveṣa)

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Secondary sources sometimes present the grouping slightly differently.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Secondary sources sometimes present the grouping slightly differently.**

66

3 Manas (mind)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Manas is an atomic internal organ.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Because mind is atomic, the self attends to one sense-cognition at a time.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Because mind is atomic, the self attends to one sense-cognition at a time.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Manas is an atomic internal organ.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Manas is an atomic internal organ.**

67

4 Distinction from Advaita

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Nyāya: consciousness is a quality of self.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Advaita: consciousness is the very nature of the self.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ This is one of the most examinable contrasts in Indian philosophy.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Nyāya: consciousness is a quality of self.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya: consciousness is a quality of self.**

68

5 Objection

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ If self without cognition can still exist, does it become an empty abstraction?

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ If self without cognition can still exist, does it become an empty abstraction?

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ If self without cognition can still exist, does it become an empty abstraction?

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ If self without cognition can still exist, does it become an empty abstraction?

ANSWER LINE: **▯ If self without cognition can still exist, does it become an empty abstraction?**

69

6 Reply

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Nyāya accepts that the self can exist without manifest cognition, as in deep sleep or liberation, because cognition depends on conjunction with mind, senses and objects.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Nyāya accepts that the self can exist without manifest cognition, as in deep sleep or liberation, because cognition depends on conjunction with mind, senses and objects.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Nyāya accepts that the self can exist without manifest cognition, as in deep sleep or liberation, because cognition depends on conjunction with mind, senses and objects.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Nyāya accepts that the self can exist without manifest cognition, as in deep sleep or liberation, because cognition depends on conjunction with mind, senses and objects.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya accepts that the self can exist without manifest cognition, as in deep sleep or liberation, because cognition depends on conjunction with mind, senses and objects.**

70

1 Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Apavarga is absolute cessation of pain: duḥkha-atyanta-nivṛtti.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ It is not primarily a positive bliss-state in Nyāya's standard formulation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ It is not primarily a positive bliss-state in Nyāya's standard formulation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ It is not primarily a positive bliss-state in Nyāya's standard formulation.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Apavarga is absolute cessation of pain: duḥkha-atyanta-nivṛtti.**

71

2 Ladder to liberation

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□□ Knowledge matters not because it reveals identity with Brahman, but because it removes error that sustains bondage-producing activity.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Knowledge matters not because it reveals identity with Brahman, but because it removes error that sustains bondage-producing activity.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ Knowledge matters not because it reveals identity with Brahman, but because it removes error that sustains bondage-producing activity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Knowledge matters not because it reveals identity with Brahman, but because it removes error that sustains bondage-producing activity.

ANSWER LINE: **tattva-jñāna → removal of mithyā-jñāna → cessation of doṣa (rāga, dveṣa, moha) → cessation of pravṛtti → cessation of janma → cessation of duḥkha → apavarga**

72

3 Nature of the liberated self

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ In mokṣa the self remains as a pure substance without pleasure, pain, desire, aversion or even ordinary cognition.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Consciousness ceases because the required conjunction of self, mind, senses and objects ceases.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Consciousness ceases because the required conjunction of self, mind, senses and objects ceases.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □ In mokṣa the self remains as a pure substance without pleasure, pain, desire, aversion or even ordinary cognition.

ANSWER LINE: **□ In mokṣa the self remains as a pure substance without pleasure, pain, desire, aversion or even ordinary cognition.**

73

4 The stone-like liberation objection

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Critics object that such liberation is "stone-like": why seek a state devoid of consciousness or bliss?

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Critics object that such liberation is "stone-like": why seek a state devoid of consciousness or bliss?

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Critics object that such liberation is "stone-like": why seek a state devoid of consciousness or bliss?

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □ Critics object that such liberation is "stone-like": why seek a state devoid of consciousness or bliss?

ANSWER LINE: **□ Critics object that such liberation is "stone-like": why seek a state devoid of consciousness or bliss?**

74

5 Nyāya reply

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ The aim is freedom from suffering, not acquisition of bliss.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Bliss may itself be relational and capable of engendering attachment; apavarga is secure because it is sheer release from all suffering-conditions.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ Bliss may itself be relational and capable of engendering attachment; apavarga is secure because it is sheer release from all suffering-conditions.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ The aim is freedom from suffering, not acquisition of bliss.

ANSWER LINE: **□ The aim is freedom from suffering, not acquisition of bliss.**

75

1 Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ God is the nimitta-kāraṇa (efficient cause), not the material cause of the world.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ God is the nimitta-kāraṇa (efficient cause), not the material cause of the world.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ The material cause remains atoms.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ God is the nimitta-kāraṇa (efficient cause), not the material cause of the world.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika affirms Īśvara as an eternal, omniscient, omnipotent being.**

76

2 Nature of God

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ God is often characterized as a special self never bound by karma.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ God is often characterized as a special self never bound by karma.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ He orders atoms at creation, dispenses karmic fruits, and in later Nyāya authors the Veda.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ God is often characterized as a special self never bound by karma.

ANSWER LINE: **□ God is often characterized as a special self never bound by karma.**

77

3 Distinction

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□□ Nyāya God is not Advaita's non-dual Brahman and not Sāṃkhya's rejected superfluity.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

He is a real personal-intelligent governor within a pluralist realist metaphysics.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

He is a real personal-intelligent governor within a pluralist realist metaphysics.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ Nyāya God is not Advaita's non-dual Brahman and not Sāṃkhya's rejected superfluity.

ANSWER LINE: **□□ Nyāya God is not Advaita's non-dual Brahman and not Sāṃkhya's rejected superfluity.**

78

1 Udayana's project

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ The exact naming and count vary somewhat across secondary presentations.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ The exact naming and count vary somewhat across secondary presentations.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

UPSC usually expects the major four and may reward mention of the extended list.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □ Udayana, especially in Nyāyakusumāñjali, develops systematic arguments for God.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Udayana, especially in Nyāyakusumāñjali, develops systematic arguments for God.**

79

(a) Kāryāt — from effect

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ The world is an effect because it is composite and made of parts.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ The world is an effect because it is composite and made of parts.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ The world is an effect because it is composite and made of parts.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: □ The world is an effect because it is composite and made of parts.

ANSWER LINE: **□ The world is an effect because it is composite and made of parts.**

80

(b) Āyojanāt — from combination/arrangement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Therefore an intelligent arranger is required: God.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Therefore an intelligent arranger is required: God.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Therefore an intelligent arranger is required: God.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Unintelligent atoms cannot purposively initiate ordered combination.

ANSWER LINE: **□ At the beginning of creation, atoms must first combine.**

81

(c) Dhṛtyādeḥ — from support/sustenance

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The order, maintenance and dissolution of the cosmos suggest sustaining intelligence.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ This moves from bare origination to continuing governance.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ This moves from bare origination to continuing governance.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ The order, maintenance and dissolution of the cosmos suggest sustaining intelligence.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The order, maintenance and dissolution of the cosmos suggest sustaining intelligence.**

82

(d) Śruteḥ — from scripture

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The Veda is authoritative knowledge.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Such authoritative revelation implies an omniscient source.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Such authoritative revelation implies an omniscient source.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ The Veda is authoritative knowledge.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The Veda is authoritative knowledge.**

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3 Additional arguments often cited

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

5. ▯ Padāt — from words / linguistic convention

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

6. ▯ Pratyayataḥ — from cognition/authoritative knowledge structure

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

7. ▯ Vākyāt — from meaningful sentences, especially Vedic sentences

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: 5. ▯ Padāt — from words / linguistic convention

ANSWER LINE: **5. ▯ Padāt — from words / linguistic convention**

84

4 Presuppositions

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯▯ These proofs presuppose that order, meaningfulness and purposiveness require intelligence rather than being emergent or brute.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ These proofs presuppose that order, meaningfulness and purposiveness require intelligence rather than being emergent or brute.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ These proofs presuppose that order, meaningfulness and purposiveness require intelligence rather than being emergent or brute.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ These proofs presuppose that order, meaningfulness and purposiveness require intelligence rather than being emergent or brute.

ANSWER LINE: **▯▯ These proofs presuppose that order, meaningfulness and purposiveness require intelligence rather than being emergent or brute.**

85

Objection 1: Sāṃkhya

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Prakṛti can explain the world; God is unnecessary.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Nyāya reply: unconscious prakṛti or atoms cannot account for purposive order and karmic allocation unaided.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Nyāya reply: unconscious prakṛti or atoms cannot account for purposive order and karmic allocation unaided.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Nyāya reply: unconscious prakṛti or atoms cannot account for purposive order and karmic allocation unaided.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Prakṛti can explain the world; God is unnecessary.**

86

Objection 2: Mīmāṃsā

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The Veda is authorless; scriptural authority does not imply God.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Nyāya reply: intelligible authoritative sentences point better to omniscient authorship.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Nyāya reply: intelligible authoritative sentences point better to omniscient authorship.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ The Veda is authorless; scriptural authority does not imply God.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The Veda is authorless; scriptural authority does not imply God.**

87

Objection 3: Problem of evil

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ If God is omnipotent and benevolent, why suffering?

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Nyāya reply: karmic order distributes fruits; God is dispenser, not arbitrary tyrant.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Nyāya reply: karmic order distributes fruits; God is dispenser, not arbitrary tyrant.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Nyāya reply: karmic order distributes fruits; God is dispenser, not arbitrary tyrant.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ If God is omnipotent and benevolent, why suffering?**

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6 Udayana's cumulative structure: not one isolated proof

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Udayana's Nyāyakusumāñjali is best read as a reply to successive objections, not as one solitary proof mechanically added to Nyāya metaphysics.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The work removes obstacles to theism step by step: that there is no unseen cause, that an unseen cause needs no intelligent controller, that Vedic authority can stand without an author, and that karma or atoms can function without governance.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

A strong answer presents Udayana's proofs as a converging or cumulative-case argument: each strand alone can be challenged, but together they are said to converge on one explanatory hypothesis.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Udayana's Nyāyakusumāñjali is best read as a reply to successive objections, not as one solitary proof mechanically added to Nyāya metaphysics.

ANSWER LINE: **Udayana's Nyāyakusumāñjali is best read as a reply to successive objections, not as one solitary proof mechanically added to Nyāya metaphysics.**

89

The explanatory hypothesis

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Thesis. Īśvara is an omniscient, eternal, bodiless agent who is the efficient (nimitta) but not material cause of the world.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Cosmic role. Īśvara conjoins atoms at the beginning of a creative cycle through volition operating with the adṛṣṭa of souls.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Moral role. Īśvara dispenses karmic fruits because unconscious adṛṣṭa cannot intelligently allot results by itself.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Thesis. Īśvara is an omniscient, eternal, bodiless agent who is the efficient (nimitta) but not material cause of the world.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Thesis. Īśvara is an omniscient, eternal, bodiless agent who is the efficient (nimitta) but not material cause of the world.**

90

Inferential forms of the main proofs

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

The proofs are commonly enumerated in different lists; where the exact traditional label is uncertain, write "commonly enumerated as" rather than inventing a fixed count.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The proofs are commonly enumerated in different lists; where the exact traditional label is uncertain, write "commonly enumerated as" rather than inventing a fixed count.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The proofs are commonly enumerated in different lists; where the exact traditional label is uncertain, write "commonly enumerated as" rather than inventing a fixed count.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

The proofs are commonly enumerated in different lists; where the exact traditional label is uncertain, write "commonly enumerated as" rather than inventing a fixed count.

ANSWER LINE: **The proofs are commonly enumerated in different lists; where the exact traditional label is uncertain, write "commonly enumerated as" rather than inventing a fixed count.**

91

Statement

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The effect does not pre-exist in its cause; it is a genuinely new beginning.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ The effect does not pre-exist in its cause; it is a genuinely new beginning.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ The effect does not pre-exist in its cause; it is a genuinely new beginning.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ The effect does not pre-exist in its cause; it is a genuinely new beginning.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika defends asatkāryavāda, also called ārambhavāda.**

92

Argument

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. ▯ Before production, the effect is absent.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

3. ▯ Production therefore brings forth a new entity.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

1. ▯ Before production, the effect is absent.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

4. ▯ Cloth is not simply threads under another description; it is a new whole produced from them.

ANSWER LINE: **1. ▯ Before production, the effect is absent.**

93

Presupposition

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯▯ The argument assumes that causal production should explain novelty, not merely manifestation.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ The argument assumes that causal production should explain novelty, not merely manifestation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ The argument assumes that causal production should explain novelty, not merely manifestation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ The argument assumes that causal production should explain novelty, not merely manifestation.

ANSWER LINE: **▯▯ The argument assumes that causal production should explain novelty, not merely manifestation.**

94

Distinction

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Contrast Sāṃkhya's satkāryavāda, where the effect pre-exists in the cause in latent form.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Contrast Sāṃkhya's satkāryavāda, where the effect pre-exists in the cause in latent form.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Contrast Sāṃkhya's satkāryavāda, where the effect pre-exists in the cause in latent form.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Contrast Sāṃkhya's satkāryavāda, where the effect pre-exists in the cause in latent form.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Contrast Sāṃkhya's satkāryavāda, where the effect pre-exists in the cause in latent form.**

95

2 Three kinds of cause

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. ▯ Samavāyi-kāraṇa — inherent/material cause

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

2. ▯ Asamavāyi-kāraṇa — non-inherent cause

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

e.g. qualities or conjunctions in the material cause that help produce the effect.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: 1. ▯ Samavāyi-kāraṇa — inherent/material cause

ANSWER LINE: **1. ▯ Samavāyi-kāraṇa — inherent/material cause**

96

3 Seed and tree (2021)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The tree is a new effect produced from the seed under appropriate conditions.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ The tree is a new effect produced from the seed under appropriate conditions.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ The tree is a new effect produced from the seed under appropriate conditions.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ So the seed is causal ground, not a concealed miniature tree in metaphysical latency.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Asked whether the seed contains the tree, Nyāya says no in the satkāryavāda sense.**

97

4 Prāgabhāva against Sāṃkhya (2023)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ This prior absence shows the effect is genuinely absent before production.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯▯ Therefore prāgabhāva becomes a sharp weapon against satkāryavāda.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Before the effect arises, it has prāgabhāva — prior non-existence.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Before the effect arises, it has prāgabhāva — prior non-existence.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Before the effect arises, it has prāgabhāva — prior non-existence.**

98

1 Paramāṇu

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ The basic physical unit is the paramāṇu — atom.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ It is eternal, partless, indivisible, imperceptible, and often described as minute/spherical (parimāṇḍalya).

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ It is eternal, partless, indivisible, imperceptible, and often described as minute/spherical (parimāṇḍalya).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ The basic physical unit is the paramāṇu — atom.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ The basic physical unit is the paramāṇu — atom.**

99

Argument

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

1. ▯ If every part had further parts without end, no ultimate physical unit would remain.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

3. ▯ Therefore atoms must be indivisible.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

3. ▯ Therefore atoms must be indivisible.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: 1. ▯ If every part had further parts without end, no ultimate physical unit would remain.

ANSWER LINE: **1. ▯ If every part had further parts without end, no ultimate physical unit would remain.**

100

3 Combination sequence

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Atoms combine into dvyaṇuka (dyads).

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Dyads combine into larger units such as tryaṇuka / trasareṇu, marking the threshold toward perceptibility in standard textbook exposition.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Gross objects arise from increasingly complex combinations.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Atoms combine into dvyaṇuka (dyads).

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Atoms combine into dvyaṇuka (dyads).**

101

4 Initiation of motion

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ At dissolution, atoms remain but compounds break apart.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ At creation, first motion must begin again.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika often invokes adṛṣṭa (unseen moral force) and the will of God as the initiator of this first motion.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ At dissolution, atoms remain but compounds break apart.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ At dissolution, atoms remain but compounds break apart.**

102

5 Cycles of creation and dissolution

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Creation (sṛṣṭi) and dissolution (pralaya) occur cyclically.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ God wills; atoms combine; the world appears.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ God wills or cosmic conditions reverse; compounds disintegrate; dissolution occurs.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Creation (sṛṣṭi) and dissolution (pralaya) occur cyclically.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Creation (sṛṣṭi) and dissolution (pralaya) occur cyclically.**

103

1 Words signify universals or particulars? (2023)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Nyāya generally leans toward words signifying objects through universals and qualificative structures, not bare particulars alone.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Nyāya generally leans toward words signifying objects through universals and qualificative structures, not bare particulars alone.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ In UPSC, answer by showing Nyāya's realist semantics: universals are objective and hence linguistically significant.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Nyāya generally leans toward words signifying objects through universals and qualificative structures, not bare particulars alone.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Nyāya generally leans toward words signifying objects through universals and qualificative structures, not bare particulars alone.**

104

2 Naiyāyika response to Cārvāka objections against anumāna (2022)

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯▯ The Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Cārvāka attacks inference by doubting universal relation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯▯ The Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ The Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Cārvāka attacks inference by doubting universal relation.**

105

1 Against universals

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika reply: exclusion presupposes stable classes; real commonness is required.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika reply: exclusion presupposes stable classes; real commonness is required.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika reply: exclusion presupposes stable classes; real commonness is required.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Buddhist objection: universals are unnecessary; exclusion explains classification.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Buddhist objection: universals are unnecessary; exclusion explains classification.**

106

2 Against samavāya

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Objection: inherence multiplies entities unnecessarily.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Reply: without a distinct inseparable relation, whole-part and quality-substance relations remain unexplained.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Reply: without a distinct inseparable relation, whole-part and quality-substance relations remain unexplained.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Objection: inherence multiplies entities unnecessarily.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Objection: inherence multiplies entities unnecessarily.**

107

3 Against stone-like mokṣa

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Objection: desire for unconscious liberation is incoherent.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Reply: complete removal of pain is a sufficient rational goal.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Reply: complete removal of pain is a sufficient rational goal.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Objection: desire for unconscious liberation is incoherent.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Objection: desire for unconscious liberation is incoherent.**

108

4 Against God proofs

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Objection: order can be explained without God.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Reply: Nyāya insists purposive order, moral dispensation and linguistic normativity are not adequately explained by blind atoms alone.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Reply: Nyāya insists purposive order, moral dispensation and linguistic normativity are not adequately explained by blind atoms alone.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯ Reply: Nyāya insists purposive order, moral dispensation and linguistic normativity are not adequately explained by blind atoms alone.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Objection: order can be explained without God.**

109

COMMON UPSC TRAPS

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯▯ Trap 1: saying Nyāya is parataḥ-prāmāṇya only for invalidity.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Nyāya allows their perception through sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

It denies pre-existent effect, not causal production.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

▯▯ Trap 1: saying Nyāya is parataḥ-prāmāṇya only for invalidity.

ANSWER LINE: **▯▯ Trap 1: saying Nyāya is parataḥ-prāmāṇya only for invalidity.**

110

KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

▯ Pratyakṣa: perceptual cognition from sense-object contact.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

▯ Dravya: substance, locus of guṇa and karma.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

▯ Asatkāryavāda / ārambhavāda: effect is a new beginning.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ▯ Padārtha: knowable/nameable category.

ANSWER LINE: **▯ Padārtha: knowable/nameable category.**

111

Quick examinable statements

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□□ "Nyāya realism extends even to error: illusion is not contact with nothing, but misrelation among reals."

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ "Vaiśeṣika multiplies categories only where explanatory need demands them."

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ "Nyāya self is enduring, but consciousness in it is episodic and conditioned."

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□□ "Nyāya realism extends even to error: illusion is not contact with nothing, but misrelation among reals."

ANSWER LINE: **□□ "Nyāya realism extends even to error: illusion is not contact with nothing, but misrelation among reals."**

112

Brown table and book on table: samavāya versus saṃyoga

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Spatial closeness is not the criterion of inherence; ontological inseparability and the relata's category relation are decisive.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ Brown colour inheres in the table through samavāya, an inseparable relation of quality and substance; the book stands on the table through saṃyoga, a contingent conjunction whose relata can exist separately.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ Spatial closeness is not the criterion of inherence; ontological inseparability and the relata's category relation are decisive.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Spatial closeness is not the criterion of inherence; ontological inseparability and the relata's category relation are decisive.

ANSWER LINE: **□ Brown colour inheres in the table through samavāya, an inseparable relation of quality and substance; the book stands on the table through saṃyoga, a contingent conjunction whose relata can exist separately.**

113

Anyathāsiddha and ananyathāsiddha

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ A causal condition is ananyathāsiddha when its relevance to the effect is not established otherwise; an anyathāsiddha condition is accidental, remote or already explained through another causal factor and is excluded from the definition of cause.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□ A causal condition is ananyathāsiddha when its relevance to the effect is not established otherwise; an anyathāsiddha condition is accidental, remote or already explained through another causal factor and is excluded from the definition of cause.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□ A causal condition is ananyathāsiddha when its relevance to the effect is not established otherwise; an anyathāsiddha condition is accidental, remote or already explained through another causal factor and is